

KenaBecha JU

Alumni Directory Proposal — Review & Gap Analysis

A comparison against “Jahangirnagar University Student & Alumni Business and Service Directory”

What the proposal asks for, how much of it KenaBecha JU already does, and what would genuinely be new to build.

August 22, 2026

Contents

1	Executive Summary	2
2	The Proposal, in Brief	2
3	Already Covered by KenaBecha JU	2
4	Comparison at a Glance	3
5	Genuine Gaps — Unique Features Worth Building	4
6	What Not to Build	5
7	Suggested Phasing	5

1 Executive Summary

A senior alumnus proposed a standalone platform — *JU Business & Service Directory* — so students and alumni running a business or offering a service can be found by category, department, and batch instead of scattered across Facebook/Messenger/WhatsApp groups. Read closely, the proposal is not a different product from KenaBecha JU; it is largely a **restatement of the same core idea** (a JU-verified marketplace of student- and alumni-run businesses, searchable and directly contactable) with a stronger emphasis on three things KenaBecha JU does not yet do: **treating department/batch/location as first-class search dimensions, a public trust badge for verified members, and a profile type for people offering a service or skill without necessarily selling a physical product.**

The recommendation is to **extend KenaBecha JU rather than build a second platform.** Roughly three quarters of the proposal — categorised business profiles, JU-identity verification, admin approval, reporting, reviews, direct contact, an admin dashboard, mobile-first design — already exists here, generally in a more capable form (real-time chat with history, a follower graph, bulk moderation, an audit log, i18n) than the ground-up MVP the proposal sketches. The genuine, worthwhile net-new work is scoped in Section 5.

2 The Proposal, in Brief

Core mechanic: a visitor searches a keyword (“Car Rental”, “Visa”, “Dates”, “Graphic Design”), optionally narrowed by department, batch, or location, and gets a list of JU-affiliated business/service providers with a name, a short description, and one-tap Call/SMS/WhatsApp/Facebook/Website contact — no more re-posting “does anyone know who rents cars?” in a Facebook group. Two profile types are proposed: a *Business/Service Profile* (shop-like: name, category, description, contact, location, logo, product photos, working hours, delivery info) and a plain *Member Profile* for people who don’t run a business but want to be discoverable by profession, skill, and department/batch, with per-field public/private visibility. Trust is built through JU-identity verification (a visible “Verified” badge), admin approval of new businesses, reviews after a transaction, and a report/moderation pipeline. The proposal explicitly recommends a small first-version MVP (registration, profiles, category search, department/batch filters, contact, admin approval, verified badge, reporting) with reviews, featured listings, and a mobile app deferred to later phases, and floats a freemium revenue model (free listings, paid “featured” placement) once there’s a real user base.

3 Already Covered by KenaBecha JU

- **JU-verified identity** — Signup already collects student ID, registration number, hall, department, session, with batch computed server-side — stronger than the proposal’s “admin approval as a first pass” suggestion, since it’s structural rather than a manual review queue.
- **Business profiles** — Shops already carry a name, description, category (`shop_type`), logo, and cover photo, and a seller can run more than one.
- **Category-based discovery** — An admin-curated, two-level category tree already exists and is exactly as extensible as the proposal’s “Transport / Travel & Visa / IT / Food / Professional Services” list — those are category rows to add, not a feature to build.
- **Keyword search** — Full-text search across titles, descriptions, and tags, with typo-tolerant trigram matching and autocomplete — more capable than the proposal’s plain keyword box.

- **Direct contact, no copy-paste** — A listing’s contact panel already renders one-tap tel: Call and WhatsApp deep links straight from the seller’s stored numbers, alongside the in-app Contact Seller flow. Only a plain SMS (sms:) link and a Facebook/website field are genuinely absent.
- **Reviews & trust** — Post-transaction star ratings with written reviews, gated to buyers who actually messaged about a completed listing — a real-transaction gate the proposal only says is “needed” without specifying how.
- **Report & moderation pipeline** — Users can report a listing, shop, or user; staff resolve as dismissed/removed/warned/banned, every action audit-logged — the proposal’s Section 14 essentially describes what Phase 41/45 already built.
- **Admin dashboard** — Headline metrics, activity charts, bulk moderation, category/navigation management, scheduled announcements — broader than the proposal’s Section 20 wishlist.
- **Following & notifications** — A follower graph per shop, with in-app and email notifications on new posts/restocks — something the proposal doesn’t have an equivalent of at all.
- **Promotional placement** — Per-listing “Top” picks and time-boxed “Featured” promotion already exist, covering the proposal’s Section 16/28 revenue idea at the listing level.
- **Mobile-first, bilingual** — Responsive design with a dedicated mobile bottom nav, full English/Bangla i18n — the proposal treats both as later-phase concerns; KenaBecha JU shipped them from the start.

4 Comparison at a Glance

Proposal feature	Status	Notes
Business/Service profile	Covered	Shops, with logo/cover/description/category.
Category taxonomy, admin-extensible	Covered	Existing two-level category tree.
Keyword search	Covered	Full-text + trigram + autocomplete.
Call / WhatsApp direct contact	Covered	Already on every listing detail page.
Reviews & ratings	Covered	Real-transaction-gated, already shipped.
Report system	Covered	Full pipeline with audit trail.
Admin approval / verification	Covered	Structural (JU fields + OTP), not a manual queue.
Admin dashboard	Covered	Broader than proposed.
Featured/paid placement	Covered	At listing level; shop-level is a gap (below).
Multiple businesses per person	Covered	A seller can run several shops today.
SMS contact button	Partial	Call/WhatsApp exist; sms: link does not.
Facebook Page / external website field	Partial	Not a stored shop field today.
Department / batch as a search filter	Gap	Fields exist on the user; not exposed as a discovery filter anywhere.
Location (city/area) search filter	Gap	Only free-text pickup_address; no structured area field or filter.
Public “Verified” trust badge	Gap	is_verified is an internal login gate, never shown publicly.

Proposal feature	Status	Notes
Non-business “Member” / professional profile	Gap	No profession/workplace/skills fields; a profile today is only “buyer or shop owner.”
Per-field privacy control (public/private)	Gap	No visibility settings; profile fields are shown or not shown by fixed code, not by user choice.
Working hours / delivery info (structured)	Gap	Only free-text description; not queryable or displayed consistently.
Shop-level (not just listing-level) featuring	Gap	Today’s promotion boosts one listing, not a whole business’s placement.
Alumni-specific onboarding (batch reps, phased rollout)	n/a	A go-to-market strategy, not a product feature.

5 Genuine Gaps — Unique Features Worth Building

These are the parts of the proposal that don’t already exist here in some form. Ordered by how directly they serve the proposal’s actual point — “find a JU person for X, fast” — rather than by how easy each is to build.

- **Department & batch as real discovery filters** — The single most distinctive idea in the proposal, and currently the biggest gap: `department_id`/`batch` already live on every user, but `browse_listings` and shop search never touch them. Surfacing “show me CSE batch 35’s businesses” turns the existing catalogue into an actual alumni network, not just a marketplace that happens to require a JU email.
- **A structured location field, with search** — A normalized area/city field on the shop (not just a free-text pickup address) plus a location filter alongside category/department/batch — the proposal’s own worked example (*Car Rental* → *CSE* → *Batch 35* → *Dhaka*) needs all four dimensions to actually combine.
- **A public “Verified JU Member” badge** — The verification data already exists (JU email OTP, structural profile fields); what’s missing is surfacing it as a visible trust signal on shop and profile pages, the way the proposal’s Section 11 describes — currently it only gates login, invisibly.
- **A non-commerce Member/Professional profile** — A profile type for someone discoverable by profession, current workplace, and skills without owning a shop or listing a product — a lawyer, doctor, or consultant who wants to be found, not to sell items with a price. This is a genuinely different data shape from a `Listing`, closer to a lightweight directory card than a product.
- **Per-field privacy controls** — Let a member choose which profile fields are public versus visible only to signed-in members — phone and address in particular. Real privacy surface area, not a checkbox: needs a settled default (private-by-default is the safer choice) and consistent enforcement everywhere a profile renders, not just the main profile page.
- **Structured business hours & delivery info** — Small, concrete fields on `Shop` (open/close per day, delivery radius or note) that render consistently rather than living inside a free-text description, which is what the proposal’s Section 4 asks for.

- **Shop-level featured placement** — A homepage/category-page promotional slot for a whole shop (not one listing), separate from the existing per-listing “Top”/“Featured” mechanism — the natural home for the proposal’s Section 16/28 monetisation idea if a paid tier is ever pursued.
- **A plain SMS contact link** — Trivial, but genuinely absent: an `sms:` deep link alongside the existing Call/WhatsApp buttons.

6 What Not to Build

The proposal’s own MVP list (registration, login, profiles, category search, department/batch filter, contact, admin approval, verified badge, report) is, item for item, close to what KenaBecha JU already has *plus* chat, follower-driven notifications, bulk moderation, and an audit trail the proposal doesn’t ask for at all. Re-building any of that as a separate “JU Business Connect” site would mean re-earning trust, re-verifying every member’s JU identity a second time, and splitting one community’s activity across two platforms with no data in common — the opposite of the proposal’s own stated goal (*one* central place instead of scattered groups). The proposal’s *Long-Term Vision* of eventually replicating the model for other universities is worth keeping in mind architecturally (nothing above is JU-specific in a way that would block it), but is not a reason to start over now.

7 Suggested Phasing

If this direction is pursued, it fits the project’s existing phase-by-phase pattern cleanly:

- **Phase A — Directory search dimensions** — Department, batch, and a structured location field, wired into `browse_listings/shop` search and their filter UI. This alone delivers the proposal’s central promise.
- **Phase B — Trust & structure** — Public verified badge, structured business hours/delivery fields, an `sms:` link.
- **Phase C — Member/Professional profiles** — The non-commerce profile type, with its own privacy controls designed alongside it from the start rather than retrofitted.
- **Phase D — Shop-level featured placement** — Only once there’s a real reason to monetise it — matching the proposal’s own advice to prioritise trust and user base over revenue at first.